VERAN: Methodology, Evaluation and Improvements

B, D and E - 7 November 2026

B. Methodology

Brand and task. VERAN is a fictional, all-gender designer fashion house offering clothing, footwear, bags and accessories. Its experimental design direction sits around RMB 3,000-8,000. The tool drafts three Chinese WeChat messages for a client advisor to review. The tone should be warm, concise and natural.

Tool design



Each request combines the shared brand rules, one scenario module and the supplied facts. The output contains three drafts and a separate advisor note. Unknown details stay unknown. Explicit contact restrictions can trigger a no-send response. The tool does not send messages.

The local workbench calls the authenticated Codex CLI. Final messages use model **gpt-6.1-terra** and prompt **veran_scenarios_v2.1**. Program checks verify output shape, candidate count and Chinese text. They do not establish factual accuracy or naturalness.

Test design

Scenario	Cases
Birthday and festive greetings	8
Product recommendation	9
Post-purchase care	8
Reactivation	8
Event invitation	8
Price objection	9

The 50 fictional inputs cover ordinary requests, missing information, changed preferences, complaints, incomplete event details and price concerns. Six cases informed one prompt revision; v2.1 was then run on all 50. This is not an untouched independent test set.

Quality definition

Good: grounded in known facts, responsive to the latest need, readable Chinese and three useful choices. **Not acceptable:** consequential invented facts or promises, contact-boundary violations, unsupported care advice, a wrong task, or missing candidates.

D. Evaluation

50 cases generated 150 actual Chinese messages. Assisted review labeled **40 groups Pass**, **10 Needs edit** and **0 Fail**. Each group consists of the three candidates for one case. No separate message-level pass rate is claimed.

Results by scenario

Scenario	Cases	Pass	Needs edit	Fail
Birthday and festive greetings	8	6	2	0
Product recommendation	9	7	2	0
Post-purchase care	8	7	1	0
Reactivation	8	8	0	0
Event invitation	8	4	4	0
Price objection	9	8	1	0

Four simple checks

Check	Pass groups	Issue groups
Facts and boundaries	50	0
Scenario and context	50	0
Chinese expression	43	7
Three useful choices	46	4

Labels and review scope

Pass: all four checks pass. **Needs edit:** minor language or candidate-variation issues. **Fail:** material factual, boundary or task failures. Provider errors are technical failures and are not counted as successful generations.

All 150 messages were read against their supplied inputs in a Codex-assisted review. There was no independent advisor panel or real-customer study. A case can have issues in more than one check. The 40 passing groups are the cases not listed in the issue table on the next page.

The main remaining problems are long or scripted invitations and repetitive alternatives. Case I05 also copies a fictional-data label into customer-facing wording. The original messages remain unchanged in C_Test_Cases.xlsx.

D. Cases requiring changes

Case ID	Scenario	Issue
G02	Birthday and festive greetings	Output 2: '值此中秋' sounds formal for a newly established WeChat relationship.
G08	Birthday and festive greetings	Output 3: '向您送上一句问候' reads stiffly; use a simpler greeting.
R04	Product recommendation	Outputs 1–3: all repeat the same two boot features and a similar invitation to learn more.
R09	Product recommendation	Outputs 1–3: largely the same knitting detail and price; little useful variation.
A01	Post-purchase care	Output 3: '想关心一下您上周买的折线衬衫' remains awkward as a check-in.
I01	Event invitation	Outputs 2–3: event details remain packed into long sentences; output 2 has a stiff closing.
I03	Event invitation	Outputs 1 and 3: dense event sentences; output 2's closing sounds scripted.
I05	Event invitation	Outputs 1–3: copy '虚构的' into customer messages and repeat almost the same content. Remove the synthetic-data label from customer-facing wording.
I08	Event invitation	Outputs 1–3: very similar topic, time/location and invitation structure; alternatives add little choice.
P06	Price objection	Outputs 1–3: repeated '具体定价依据' is technical and stiff; use simpler everyday language.

Evidence status: generation/evaluation screenshots and earlier AI-chat screenshots remain pending. Saved logs and reformatted records are not presented as screenshots.

E. Defects and improvements

The six v2.0 development cases exposed long sentences, ceremonial check-ins, repeated hedging and an unsupported advisor action. Version v2.1 added short-sentence guidance, everyday wording and an explicit rule against inventing actions. Business facts and policies were not changed.

X01 - candidate 2

Before: v2.0

> 您好，最近整理到一份品牌的剪裁设计介绍，想起您之前说过可以分享这方面的内容。如果您感兴趣，我发给您。

After: v2.1

> 您好，之前您提过对剪裁内容感兴趣。这份品牌设计介绍想分享给您，有空时随意翻翻。

Removed the unsupported advisor action "recently compiled". The revised message refers to the client's stated interest.

A01 - candidate 3

Before: v2.0

> 林女士，您好！想就您上周购买的折线衬衫向您问候一下。您方便的时候，如果有什么想交流的，给我留言就好。

After: v2.1

> 林女士，您好。想关心一下您上周买的折线衬衫。之后有需要了解的，欢迎随时联系我。

Reduced ceremonial language. The final candidate is still awkward and remains marked Needs edit.

P01 - candidate 1

Before: v2.0

> 理解您对价格的考虑，这件西装能否打折，我可以先帮您核实。

After: v2.1

> 您关心折扣，我先帮您核实一下。

Shortened the acknowledgement while preserving the need to verify the unknown discount policy.

Next steps

Remove synthetic-data labels from customer messages, shorten event invitations and improve useful variation. Re-run affected cases under a new version and retain original outputs. Add explicit no-contact and embedded-instruction boundary cases, seek advisor review, and complete the screenshot evidence.

Before/after examples are from the same case and candidate index. They illustrate actual revisions, not a controlled causal estimate of improvement.